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Power tool and method for carrying out charge equalization between accumulators in a power tool

Abstract

A power tool having a first accumulator and a second accumulator, wherein the power tool has a first power electronics system with a first inverter and a second power electronics system with a second inverter, wherein the first inverter is electrically connected to the first accumulator and the second inverter is electrically connected to the second accumulator. The first power electronics system includes a first charge equalization device while the second power electronics system includes a second charge equalization device. The charge equalization devices are configured to carry out charge equalization between the accumulators. Furthermore, the power tool includes a device for speed control. In a second aspect, the invention relates to a method for carrying out charge equalization between two accumulators in a power tool. In this case, the charge equalization is preferably carried out by different load splitting via the charge equalization devices of the power electronics systems.

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Background/Summary

(1) The invention relates to a power tool with a first accumulator and a second accumulator. In a second aspect, the invention relates to a method for carrying out charge equalization between two accumulators in a power tool.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(2) Power tools with which different types of work can be carried out are known in the prior art. For example, hammer drills, chisels, cut-off or angle grinders, screwdrivers or core drills are known in each of which a tool is driven by a motor. A power supply can be provided via a mains connection or with batteries or accumulators.

(3) A number of applications of such power tools are known, in which high powers are required in order to carry out the corresponding work. In the case of power tools whose power supply is formed by an accumulator, it can happen that the power required for the work exceeds the maximum possible output power of the accumulator. In order to meet this challenge, such power tools are often equipped with an interface for two accumulators in order to be able to provide the desired power with two accumulators that can be connected in series or in parallel.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(4) However, when working with power tools with two accumulators, the following problem can arise: If one of the accumulators is completely or partially discharged, full power cannot be provided for the power tool over the entire working period. As soon as one of the accumulators is completely discharged, no further power can be drawn from the accumulators. It may then be necessary to stop working with the power tool-despite the remaining charge present in one of the two accumulators.

(5) Power tools with two accumulators, in which the accumulators are connected in series and are guided to a power electronics system, are known from the prior art. In conventional power tools of this kind, the power electronics system and the motor of the power tool are designed for a double operating voltage. In this case, the double operating voltage corresponds to double the voltage of one of the accumulators. For example, DE 11 2017 002 637 T5 discloses a system with two battery packs, wherein the first battery pack is selectively connected electrically in series with the second battery pack.

(6) Furthermore, power tools whose motors comprise a plurality of winding systems or winding groups are known in the prior art.

(7) One disadvantage of these power tools, as are known from the prior art, is that the total power is critically determined by the performance capability of the weaker accumulator in each case.

Splitting the individual powers with regard to the state of the accumulator is not possible.

According to the invention, such splitting of the individual powers is preferably referred to as “unidirectional adjustment”. After the disconnection of an undervoltage in one of the two accumulators, there may be a considerable residual charge which also can no longer be utilized without charging the power tool or its accumulators.

(8) An object of the present invention is therefore to overcome the above-described deficiencies and disadvantages of the prior art and to provide a power tool with at least two accumulators and a method for carrying out charge equalization between two accumulators in a power tool, with which improved charge equalization between the accumulators is to be made possible. A particular concern of the invention is also that the charge equalization should take place in both directions. Those skilled in the art would also appreciate it if a technical solution could be provided with which charge equalization between the accumulators of a power tool can be carried out at least also during operation or while working with the power tool.

(9) In a first aspect, the present invention provides a power tool with a first accumulator and a second accumulator, wherein the power tool has a first power electronics system with a first inverter and a second power electronics system with a second inverter, wherein the first inverter is electrically connected to the first accumulator and the second inverter is electrically connected to

the second accumulator. The first power electronics system comprises a first charge equalization device and the second power electronics system comprises a second charge equalization device, wherein the charge equalization devices are configured to carry out charge equalization between the accumulators. The power tool comprises at least one device for speed control, wherein the at least one device for speed control is connected upstream of the charge equalization devices.

(10) The invention relates, in particular, to a drive system for an electric power tool. The power tool can comprise a brushless motor, wherein the motor according to the present invention is energized by two accumulators and power electronics systems which are separated from one another. In other words, a power tool with two separated power electronics systems, in which power tool the two accumulators are connected to the motor of the power tool by means of the power electronics systems, can be provided by the invention. It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the components of the system are linked or interact with one another such that energization of the motor is optimized based on the states of the accumulators during normal operation of the power tool. This optimization can be achieved by way of the charge equalization devices of the power electronics systems being configured for carrying out charge equalization between the accumulators. It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the charge equalization devices provided for carrying out charge equalization constitute control blocks for optimized splitting of a power between the accumulators. The charges are preferably equalized by currents or current flows, wherein the current flows can be ascertained using the formulae indicated below.

(11) The at least one device for speed control is connected upstream of the charge equalization devices. In other words, this means that the speed control device is provided upstream of the “balancing control block” within the power electronics system. Therefore, the speed control device is provided upstream of the charge equalization device within the power path, i.e. the charge equalization takes place after any speed control. It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the device for controlling the speed of the power tool is a constituent part of the power electronics system. It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that each of the two power electronics systems comprises a device for speed control. However, it may also be preferred that only one of the two power electronics systems has a speed control device.

(12) In the context of the present invention, the electrical power path leads, starting from the two accumulators, via separated power electronics systems, to the motor of the power tool. The motor can—as will be outlined in more detail later—have separated winding systems. Within the meaning of the invention, this preferably means that the motor of the power tool, which preferably has a rotor and a stator, comprises two winding systems. Within the meaning of the invention the stator of the motor of the power tool comprises a first and a second winding system, so that the stator of the motor of the power tool is preferably referred to as a “double-wound stator” within the meaning of the invention. The motor preferably comprises a rotor and a stator with a first winding system and a second winding system. Within the meaning of the invention, it is particularly preferred that the winding system is in the form of a three-phase winding system. Within the meaning of the invention, this preferably means that the motor of the power tool preferably comprises three motor phases per winding system. It is provided within the meaning of the invention that a winding system in a three-phase motor comprises three windings, wherein the windings can be connected in star and or in delta.

(13) The power electronics systems of the power tool each comprise an inverter. In this case, the first inverter is electrically connected to the first accumulator and the second inverter is electrically connected to the second accumulator. The electrically conductive connection between the inverters and the accumulators is preferably also referred to as “assignment of the inverters to the accumulators” within the meaning of the invention. The charge equalization between the accumulators of the power tool can be optimized in particular by way of the first and the second inverter of the power electronics systems being configured to ascertain state data relating to the accumulators. The state data can then be interchanged via a communication connection, which

exists between the inverters. In this case, raw data can be exchanged, for example. However, it may also be preferred within the meaning of the invention for data that has already been processed or the results of evaluations and analyses which are carried out within the inverter to be exchanged. The communication connection may be in the form of, for example, a Controller Area Network (CAN) or a Universal Asynchronous Receiver Transmitter (UART).

(14) The power electronics systems comprise sensors and/or measuring devices for detecting the state data. In this case, for example, voltages are preferably detected directly via a potentiometer by an internal analog/digital converter (ADC) and digitized. The current can be measured, for example, by means of a shunt, wherein in particular a voltage drop is ascertained and evaluated in order to obtain the values for the electric current.

(15) It is very particularly preferred within the meaning of the invention that the power tool comprises a sensor system for detecting a position of the rotor of the power tool. This may preferably be an angle indication α_{Rotor} . This sensor system can preferably be supplied with electrical energy from the power electronics systems. It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the position of the rotor of the power tool is detected and used in order to correctly energize the motor phases of the motor. Furthermore, the speed or the angular speed of the motor can also be ascertained from this sensor signal.

(16) It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the power electronics systems comprise control devices. Consequently, the first power electronics system comprises a first control device, while the second power electronics system comprises a second control device. It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the control devices are preferably also referred to as “controllers”. The sensors and measuring devices advantageously supply measurement and state data to the two controllers. It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the measurement and state data ascertained by the sensors and measuring devices constitute for example angular signals, voltages, currents and/or temperatures. It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that, in particular, the control devices of the power electronics systems communicate with one another via the communication connection.

(17) It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the state data which are ascertained by the power electronics systems or their measurement and sensor systems comprise current values and/or voltage values which describe a performance of the accumulators. The power electronics systems can preferably ascertain a state of the accumulators associated with them by measuring the operating variables voltage (U_1 , U_2) and/or current (I_1 , I_2). Here, the index “1” stands for the current or voltage values of the first accumulator, while the index “2” describes the current or voltage values of the second accumulator. A substantial advantage of the invention is that a performance of the accumulators can be ascertained using the current and/or voltage values.

(18) Charge equalization between the accumulators of the power tool can be rendered possible, for example, by optimization based on the voltage values of the accumulators. Charge equalization is performed, in particular, using the charge equalization devices of the power electronics systems of the power tool. These charge equalization devices constitute what are known as “balancing control blocks”, in which the equalization currents are preferably given as follows:

$$(19) I_{\text{equalized}_1} = I \cdot \text{Math. } U_1 / (U_1 + U_2) \text{ and } I_{\text{equalized}_2} = I \cdot \text{Math. } U_2 / (U_1 + U_2)$$

(20) Here, the letter “I” preferably stands for the target current from the speed controller.

(21) It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the state data for optimizing the charge equalization are selected from a group comprising: charge of the accumulators, temperature of the accumulators, source voltage of the accumulators, maximum discharge current of the accumulators and/or optimum discharge current of the accumulators, without being restricted to these.

Furthermore, a temperature of the electronics system of the power tool can be used to optimize charge equalization between the two accumulators of the power tool. In general form, the above-mentioned formula can be described using further optimization criteria k and weightings n as follows:

(22) $I_{\text{equalized}_2} = I \cdot \text{Math.}(n_1 \cdot \text{Math.}(k_1 + n_2 \cdot \text{Math.}(k_2 + n_3 \cdot \text{Math.}(k_3 + \dots \text{Math.}(\dots$

(23) In order to use further optimization potential, properties and states of the accumulators can be detected via a communication connection to a battery management system (BMS) and/or a cell management system (CMS). In the context of the present invention, the term “cell management system (CMS)” can also be used as a synonym for the term “cell managing system (CMS)”. In addition, the power tool can comprise a battery management system and/or a cell management system, wherein the battery management system and/or the cell management system are/is configured to detect state data relating to the accumulators of the power tool. A refinement of the invention with a battery management system (BMS) is depicted in FIG. 6.

(24) Within the meaning of the invention, it is preferred that the power electronics systems comprise devices for current control. These devices for current control are preferably connected downstream of the charge equalization devices. In other words, this means that the current control device is provided downstream of the “balancing control block” within the power electronics system. Therefore, the current control device is preferably provided downstream of the charge equalization device within the power path, i.e. the charge equalization is performed before any current control. It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the device for controlling the current is a constituent part of the power electronics system.

(25) It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the device for speed control, the device for current control and/or the inverters are implemented in the form of block, trapezoidal or sinusoidal commutation.

(26) In a second aspect, the invention relates to a method for carrying out charge equalization between two accumulators in a power tool, wherein the method is characterized by the following method steps: a) operating the power tool, wherein a motor of the power tool is supplied with electrical energy by the first accumulator and the second accumulator, b) ascertaining state data relating to the accumulators using the power electronics systems, c) carrying out speed control using an device for speed control of the power tool, d) carrying out charge equalization between the accumulators as a function of the previously ascertained state data using the charge equalization devices of the power electronics systems.

(27) The charge equalization is advantageously carried out by different load splitting by means of the charge equalization devices of the power electronics systems.

(28) In the structure of an electric motor, a rotor is arranged inside the motor, while the stator is arranged around the rotor. The stator can, for example, comprise three stator coil pairs, each of which can consist of a first and a second stator coil. The stator coils can in particular be arranged in a circle around the rotor of the motor of the power tool. It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the stator coils of a stator coil pair are substantially opposite one another within the stator.

(29) It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the stator coils of the stator are wound identically or substantially identically in the sense that their windings comprise a first wire layer and a second wire layer, with the wire layers being formed in such a way that they allow operation of the motor of the power tool at a speed in the range of the speed of a comparison motor, but at substantially half the power compared with the comparison motor. The operation of the motor at half the power compared with a comparison motor is made possible in particular by the provision of two wire layers present in the stator coils and forming a first and a second winding of the stator of the motor of the power too.

(30) In one refinement of the invention, it is preferred that the first stator coils comprise the first winding and the second stator coils comprise the second winding. In this refinement, the stator preferably comprises three coil pairs, wherein each pair comprises first and a second coil. The first coils, i.e. the first coil of the first, the second and the third coil pair, comprise the first winding of the stator, while the second coils, i.e. the second coil of the first, the second and the third coil pair, comprise the second winding of the stator. Such a preferred refinement of the invention is

illustrated in FIG. 4.

(31) It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the stator is wound twice in a substantially identical manner. The provision of a stator with two windings is preferably referred to as a “double-wound stator” within the meaning of the invention. The “double winding” is achieved in particular by the first winding and the second winding of the stator, the windings each comprising a wire layer. The winding with the first wire layer forms the first winding of the stator coil and the winding with the second wire layer forms the second winding of the stator coil. Preferably, each of the windings is designed such that the winding can operate the power tool motor at full speed and half power. The double-wound stator thus acts like two individual motors, which, however, are arranged or wound on a stator. It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the partial powers of the two windings substantially add up to the total power of a comparison motor, the stator coils of the comparison motor being substantially completely wrapped with a continuous wire layer. In other words, this last subordinate clause preferably means that the full or half power or speed is specified in the context of the present invention in relation to a comparison motor, the notional comparison motor being characterized in that it is substantially completely wrapped with a continuous wire layer. It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the coils of the comparison motor have the same number of turns, but twice the wire diameter, compared to the coils of the motor of the present invention. In other words, the coils of the comparison motor are wound with a wire whose diameter is substantially twice the size of that in the motor of the present invention.

(32) It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the first winding of the stator coils is energized by a first inverter, while the second winding of the stator coils is energized by a second inverter, so that the sum of the two windings allows a power in the range of the comparison motor to be provided for the motor of the power tool. In other words, substantially the entire power of a comparison motor can be approached if the windings of the stator are each energized by an inverter. Preferably, each winding contributes substantially half of the total power of a comparison motor. In other words, the nominal contribution of each of the two winding layers is approximately 50% of the power of the comparison motor.

(33) It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the comparison motor does not comprise two windings or two wire layers, but only one winding and one wire layer that forms the winding.

(34) In the context of the invention, a method for operating a power tool is provided, wherein the first winding of the stator coils is energized by a first inverter, while the second winding of the stator coils is energized by a second inverter, so that a power in the range of the comparison motor is provided for the motor of the power tool. It is particularly preferred within the meaning of the invention that the full power of the motor can be provided by energizing the windings through the two inverters, with this full power preferably corresponding to the full power of the comparison motor.

(35) It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the first wire layers of the stator coils, which form a first winding, are energized by a first inverter, while the second wire layers, which form a second winding, are energized by a second inverter.

(36) It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the power tool comprises a first accumulator and a second accumulator. With the double-wound stator in the context of the present invention, charge equalization between the accumulators of the power tool can be carried out in a particularly simple manner. In particular, it is possible for the charge equalization to take place in both directions. This charge equalization on both sides can take place in particular when the power tool is at a standstill.

(37) It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the first accumulator has a first charge state and the second accumulator has a second charge state, with the charge states being able to be equalized by means of the charge equalization described above, in particular with the aid of the

bridge circuit, when the power tool is at a standstill. For example, if the first charge state of the first accumulator is 75% and the second charge state of the second accumulator is 25%, charge equalization can be carried out with the invention with the aim that at its end both accumulators have a charge state of around 50%. In particular, charge equalization carried out in this way enables the power tool to be used effectively for longer because the charges can be better distributed within the accumulators and can thus be utilized. In particular, the situation is avoided in which work with the power tool has to be ended although one of the accumulators is still well charged.

(38) FIG. 3 shows a preferred refinement of the invention, in which the first winding is connected to a first accumulator via a first inverter, while the second winding is connected to a second accumulator via a second inverter. With the circuit shown in FIG. 3, charge equalization can advantageously be made possible both during operation and when the power tool is at a standstill.

(39) In the context of the present invention, a method for carrying out charge equalization between two accumulators in a power tool is also disclosed, wherein the power tool comprises a first inverter for energizing first stator coils and a second inverter for energizing second stator coils, wherein the inverters form a bridge circuit with the stator coils that is configured to carry out charge equalization between the accumulators of the power tool. It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the stator coils form a stator that has a first winding and a second winding, with charge equalization being achieved by electrical energy being transferred from the first winding to the second winding of the stator, or vice versa.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Further advantages will become apparent from the following description of the figures. An exemplary embodiment of the present invention is depicted in the figures. The figures, the description and the claims contain numerous features in combination. A person skilled in the art will expediently also consider the features individually and combine them to produce useful further combinations.

(2) Identical and similar components are denoted by the same reference signs in the figures, in which:

(3) FIG. 1 shows an exemplary embodiment of a double-wound stator according to a preferred refinement of the invention

(4) FIGS. 2a, 2b, 2c show an illustration of a possible refinement of the stator with three stator coil pairs

(5) FIG. 3 shows an exemplary circuit diagram for a double-wound stator with two accumulators

(6) FIG. 4 shows an illustration of a preferred refinement of the stator, in which the first and the second winding are respectively arranged on the first and second coils of the stator coil pairs

(7) FIG. 5 shows an exemplary structure of a basic circuit of a power tool with two accumulators

(8) FIG. 6 shows an illustration of a preferred embodiment of the invention with a battery management system (BMS)

(9) FIG. 7 shows an exemplary structure of a preferred embodiment of the first power electronics system of the power tool with two accumulators

(10) FIG. 8 shows an illustration of a preferred embodiment of the invention with just one speed controller

(11) FIGS. 9a and 9b show an illustration of a preferred embodiment of the two winding systems of the invention

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(12) FIGS. 1 to 4 disclose details of the motor 12 of the power tool 10. Details and circuit diagrams of the method for carrying out charge equalization and of the power tool 10 provided for said

method can be found in FIGS. 5 to 8.

(13) FIG. 1 shows an exemplary refinement of the motor **12** of the power tool **10**, with a power tool **10** not being shown in the figures. In FIG. 1 there can be seen the rotor **14** and the stator **16** of the motor **12** of the power tool **10**, which is preferably a brushless electric motor. The stator **16** comprises a series of stator coils **20**, **30** which can be arranged in pairs, for example, or can form stator coil pairs **18a**, **18b**, **18c** (see, e.g., FIG. 2). In each case one group of stator coils can preferably be referred to as first stator coils **20** and the other group of stator coils can preferably be referred to as second stator coils **30**. The stator **16** of the motor **12** of the power tool **10** comprises a first winding **70** and a second winding **80**, it being possible for the windings **70**, **80** to each comprise a wire layer (see, e.g. FIG. 3). It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the first winding **70** comprises a first wire layer, while the second winding **80** comprises a second wire layer. In one possible refinement of the invention, each stator coil **20**, **30** comprises a first wire layer and a second wire layer, the first wire layers of the stator coils **20**, **30** forming the first winding **70** of the stator **16**, while the second wire layers of the stator coils **20**, **30** form the second winding **80** of the stator **16**. In another refinement of the invention, the first stator coils include the first winding and the second stator coils the second winding. In other words, in this refinement of the invention, the first winding **70** is wound around the group of first stator coils **20**, while the second winding **80** is wound around the group of second stator coils **30**.

(14) Each of the two windings **70**, **80** allows the power tool **10** to be operated in such a way that full speed can be achieved, but only half the power compared with the operation of a comparison motor. The comparison motor substantially corresponds to the motor, but the stator of the comparison motor has only one winding, i.e. one wire layer. Preferably, each of the two windings **70**, **80** of the double-wound stator **16** is energized by an inverter **24**, **34**, with the first winding **70** of the stator **16** of the motor **12** of the power tool **10** being energized by the first inverter **24**, while the second winding **80** of the stator **16** of the motor **12** of the power tool **10** is energized by the second inverter **34**. As a result, the total power of the motor **12** can advantageously be approached, with each winding layer **70**, **80** nominally contributing substantially 50% to the power of the motor **12**. The lines coming from the rotor **12** in FIG. 1 preferably run in the direction of the inverters **24**, **34**.

(15) It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the stator **16** of the power tool **10** has stator coils **20**, **30**, with the stator coils **20**, **30** forming a bridge circuit **90** with the inverters **24**, **34**. The motor **12** of the power tool **10** is preferably a brushless motor.

(16) In addition, FIG. 1 shows the electrical lines, which can exist between the first wire layers **22** of adjacent stator coils **20**, **30** in each case. Electrical lines can be arranged on the inside of the stator **16** and in each case connect the first wire layers within a stator coil **20**, **30** to one another. The inside of the stator **16** preferably faces the rotor **14** of the motor **12** of the power tool **10**, since the rotor **14** of the motor **12** of the power tool **10** is arranged inside the motor **12** of the power tool **10**.

(17) FIGS. 2a, 2b, 2c shows a possible embodiment of the stator **16** of the motor **12** of the power tool **10** with three stator coil pairs **18**. Each stator coil pair **18a**, **18b**, **18c** preferably comprises a first stator coil **20** and a second stator coil **30**, with this first stator coil **20** and the second stator coil **30**, which together form a stator coil pair **18**, preferably being situated opposite one another in the stator **16** of the motor **12** of the power tool **10**. The three stator coil pairs **18** are designated as stator coil pairs **18a**, **18b** and **18c** in FIG. 2 and sub-FIGS. 2a, 2b and 2c.

(18) FIG. 3 shows a circuit diagram for a preferred embodiment of the double-wound stator **16** with two inverters **24**, **34**. The stator **16** of the motor **12** of the power tool **10** is shown in the center of FIG. 3. The letters A, B, C stand for the three stator coil pairs **18a**, **18b** and **18c**, while the numbers **1** and **2** indicate whether it is the first stator coil **20** or the second stator coil **30** of a stator coil pair **18**. In other words, the stator coils A1, B1, C1 form the first stator coils **20** of the stator coil pairs **18**, while the stator coils A2, B2 and C2 form the second stator coils **30** of the stator coil pairs **18**. The first stator coils A1, B1, C1 are preferably connected to a first inverter **24**, while the second

stator coils **A2**, **B2** and **C2** are preferably connected to a second inverter **34**. It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the inverters **24**, **34** and the stator coils **20**, **30** form a bridge circuit **90** or an H-bridge, with charge equalization between the accumulators **40**, **50** of the power tool **10** being able to be allowed via this bridge circuit **90**. This is possible in particular because the motor **12** of the power tool **10** is used as a direct current/direct current converter. This allows electrical energy to be transferred from the first winding **70** of the stator **16** to the second winding **80** of the stator **16**, or vice versa. Owing to the possibility of transferring electrical energy from one winding **70** of the stator **16** to another winding **80**, the energy can also be transferred from one accumulator **40** to the other accumulator **50**, so that any differences in charge can be equalized. This method for charge equalization can be carried out in particular when the power tool **10** is at a standstill. Its particular advantage is that electrical energy can be transmitted in both directions.

(19) With the invention of the double-wound stator **16**, charge equalization can also be carried out during the operation of the power tool **10**. For this purpose, the inverter (e.g.: **24**), which is connected to the accumulator to be charged (e.g.: **40**, see. e.g., FIG. 5), can be switched over from motor operation to generator operation. As a result, the capacity of the fuller accumulator (e.g.: **50**) can be used to recharge the accumulator (e.g.: **40**) with the lower charge state. This method can be made possible in particular by imparting a small braking torque.

(20) FIG. 4 shows an illustration of a preferred refinement of the stator **16**, in which the first winding **70** and the second winding **80** are respectively arranged on the first coils **20** and second coils **30** of the stator coil pairs **18**. In other words, it is preferred that the first stator coils **20** comprise the first winding **70** of the stator **16** and the second stator coils **30** comprise the second winding **80** of the stator **16**. In this refinement of the invention, the stator **16** preferably comprises three coil pairs **18**, with each coil pair **18a**, **18b**, **18c** comprising a first coil **20** and a second coil **30**. The first coils **20**, i.e. the first coil **20** of the first coil pair **18a**, of the second coil pair **18b** and of the third coil pair **18c**, comprise the first winding **70** of the stator **16** of the motor **12** of the power tool **10**, while the second coils **30**, i.e. the second coil **30** of the first coil pair **18a**, of the second coil pair **18b** and of the third coil pair **18c**, comprise the second winding **80** of the stator **16**. The first stator coils **20** are designated **A1**, **B1**, **C1** in FIG. 4, while the second stator coils **30** are designated **A2**, **B2**, **C2** in FIG. 4.

(21) It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the embodiment of the invention shown in FIG. 4 can also be used for operating the motor **12** of the power tool **10** or for carrying out charge equalization between the accumulators **40**, **50**. In this case, the first winding **70** of the stator **16** is energized by a first inverter **24**, while the second winding **80** is energized by a second inverter **34**. The windings **70**, **80** are designed such that they can operate the motor **12** of the power tool **10** at full speed, but at half the power compared with a comparison motor. In total, the full power can be provided for operation of the power tool **10** by energizing the two windings **70**, **80**. In the context of this preferred refinement of the invention, the inverters **24**, **34** and the stator coils **20**, **30** also form a bridge circuit **90** or an H-bridge, with which charge equalization between the accumulators **40**, **50** can be carried out. Charge equalization is preferably performed by way of electrical energy being transmitted from the first winding **70** to the second winding **80** of the stator **16**, or vice versa.

(22) FIG. 5 shows an exemplary structure of a basic circuit of a power tool **10** with two accumulators **40**, **50**. The accumulators **40**, **50** are connected to the motor **12** of the power tool **10** by means of the motor inverters **24**, **34** and supply the motor **12** with electrical energy. In particular, the first accumulator **40** is connected to the motor **12** by means of the first inverter **24**, while the second accumulator **50** is connected to the motor **12** by means of the second inverter **34**. A communication connection **60** exists between the inverters **24**, **34**, via which communication connection state data of the components of the power tool **10** or operating parameters can be exchanged. The inverters **24**, **34** are each a constituent part of a power electronics system **120**, **130** (see, e.g., FIG. 8) and control the supply of electrical energy to the motor **12** or charge equalization

between the accumulators **40**, **50**. It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the first inverter **24** is a constituent part of the first power electronics system **120**, while the second inverter **34** is a constituent part of the second power electronics system **130**. The communication connection **60** may be in the form of a CAN or UART connection.

(23) FIG. **6** shows a preferred embodiment of the invention with a battery management system (BMS). In particular, FIG. **6** shows a detail of the first power electronics system **120** of the power tool **10**. The first power electronics system **120** comprises the first motor inverter **24**, which is configured to communicate with the battery management system (BMS) via a second communication connection **61**. In FIG. **6**, the letter «I» stands for the battery current, and the letter «U» stands for the battery voltage. These variables are preferably required for the charge equalization devices **100**, **110**.

(24) FIG. **7** shows an exemplary structure of a preferred embodiment of the first power electronics system **120** of the power tool **10** with two accumulators **40**, **50**. A device for speed control **32**, a first charge equalization device **100**, a device **122** for controlling a current flow and a first inverter **24** are depicted as components of the first power electronics system **120** in FIG. **7**. Within the meaning of the invention, the charge equalization device **100** can preferably also be referred to as a “balancing control block”. It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the power tool **10** has a first power electronics system **120** and a second power electronics system **130**, with the second power electronics system **130** preferably being constructed in a manner corresponding to the first power electronics system **120**. Starting from the motor **12**, the second power electronics system **130** comprises a second inverter **34**, a device **22** for controlling a current flow, a second charge equalization device **110** and a device for speed control **32**.

(25) FIG. **8** shows a preferred embodiment of the invention with just one device for speed control **32**. It can be preferred within the meaning of the invention that the power tool **10** comprises only one device for speed control **32**, which is then preferably arranged upstream of the charge equalization devices **100**, **110**. In the refinement of the invention illustrated in FIG. **8**, the power path again splits into a first power electronics system **120** and a second power electronics system **130** downstream of the charge equalization device **100**, **110**, with the first power electronics system **120** comprising a device **222** for measuring a current flow, as well as a first motor inverter **24**. The second power electronics system **130** preferably likewise comprises a device **222** for measuring a current flow, as well as the second motor inverter **32**.

(26) It is preferred within the meaning of the invention that the power tool **10** comprises a charge equalization device (**100** or **110**), with this one charge equalization device (**100** or **110**) being connected to one of the inverters (**24** or **34**) or being a constituent part thereof. However, it may also be provided within the meaning of the invention that the power tool **10** comprises two charge equalization devices (**100** or **110**), with a respective charge equalization device (**100** or **110**) being associated with each inverter **24**, **34**. The actual currents I_{act} , which come from the inverter blocks **24**, **34**, are also depicted in FIG. **8**. The current “I” between the speed controller **32** and the charge equalization device (**100** or **110**) symbolizes the target current from the speed controller **32**.

(27) FIGS. **9a** and **9b** show a preferred embodiment of the two winding systems **70**, **80** of the invention.

LIST OF REFERENCE SIGNS

(28) **10** Power tool **12** Motor of the power tool **14** Rotor **16** Stator **18** Stator coil pair **20** First stator coil **22** Device for current control **24** First inverter **30** Second stator coil **32** Device for speed control **34** Second inverter **40** First accumulator **50** Second accumulator **60** Communication connection between the inverters **61** Second communication connection between an inverter and the battery management system (BMS) **70** First winding **80** Second winding **90** H-bridge or bridge circuit **100** First charge equalization device **110** Second charge equalization device **120** First power electronics system **130** Second power electronics system

Claims

1. A power tool comprising: a first accumulator; a second accumulator; a first power electronics system with a first inverter; a second power electronics system with a second inverter, wherein the first inverter is electrically connected to the first accumulator and the second inverter is electrically connected to the second accumulator; the first power electronics system including a first charge equalizer and the second power electronics system including a second charge equalizer, the first and second charge equalizers configured to carry out charge equalization between the first and second accumulators; and a speed controller, the speed controller connected upstream of the first and second charge equalizers; the first and second power electronics system each having a current flow controller downstream of the first and second charge equalizers.
2. The power tool as recited in claim 1 further comprising a motor having a rotor and a stator with a first winding and a second winding.
3. The power tool as recited in claim 1 wherein the first and second inverters are configured to ascertain state data relating to the first and second accumulators and to exchange the state data via a communication connection existing between the first and second inverters.
4. The power tool as recited in claim 3 wherein the state data include current values or voltage values describing a performance of the first and second accumulators.
5. The power tool as recited in claim 3 wherein the state data are selected from at least one of a group consisting of: charge, temperature, source voltage, maximum discharge current, and optimum discharge current of the first and second accumulators.
6. The power tool as recited in claim 1 wherein the speed controller, a current controller or the first and second inverters are implemented in the form of block, trapezoidal or sinusoidal commutation.
7. The power tool as recited in claim 2 wherein the motor is a brushless motor.
8. The power tool as recited in claim 1 further comprising a battery management system or a cell management system.
9. The power tool as recited in claim 8 wherein the battery management system or the cell management system is configured to detect state data relating to the first and second accumulators.
10. A method for carrying out charge equalization between two accumulators in a power tool as recited in claim 1, the method comprising the following steps: a) operating the power tool, a motor of the power tool being supplied with electrical energy by the first accumulator and the second accumulator; b) ascertaining state data relating to the first and second accumulators using the first and second power electronics systems; c) carrying out speed control using the speed controller; d) carrying out charge equalization between the first and second accumulators as a function of the previously ascertained state data using the first and second charge equalization devices of the first and second power electronics systems; the first and second power electronics system each having a current flow controller downstream of the first and second charge equalizers.
11. The method as recited in claim 10 wherein the charge equalization is implemented by different load splitting.
12. A power tool comprising: a first accumulator; a second accumulator; a first power electronics system with a first inverter; a second power electronics system with a second inverter, wherein the first inverter is electrically connected to the first accumulator and the second inverter is electrically connected to the second accumulator; the first power electronics system including a first charge equalizer and the second power electronics system including a second charge equalizer, the first and second charge equalizers configured to carry out charge equalization between the first and second accumulators; and a speed controller, the speed controller connected upstream of the first and second charge equalizers; wherein the first and second inverters are configured to ascertain state data relating to the first and second accumulators and to exchange the state data via a communication connection existing between the first and second inverters.

13. The power tool as recited in claim 12 wherein the state data include current values or voltage values describing a performance of the first and second accumulators.

14. The power tool as recited in claim 12 wherein the state data are selected from at least one of a group consisting of: charge, temperature, source voltage, maximum discharge current, and optimum discharge current of the first and second accumulators.
